expectations, such as in Kerala, Maharashtra, Telangana, Karnataka and Rajasthan, this shows that the Congress organization as a whole was not organically connected to mass movements and aligned forces). Young Congress workers who took part in various segments were themselves pleasantly surprised by the way people came forward without being mobilized. This undoubtedly had an energizing effect on the party and the workers.

It is this spirit and promise of the BJY that was channelized in the electoral mobilization by non-political/social and cultural organizations in Karnataka. Under the 'Eddelu Karnataka (Wake Up Karnataka)' movement, close to a hundred social organizations came together to mobilize popular dissent against the BJP. They did not ask the voters to vote for the Congress, but reminded them of the consequences of voting for the BJP. The Congress was the default beneficiary. These organizations worked independent of the Congress. Perhaps in a first-of-its-kind experiment, social activists influenced electoral politics and its outcome. It closed the gap between the social and the political, once again reminding us of the necessity to back political work with a 'constructive programme' and challenging the perceived wisdom that social-normative calls for love or justice have no electoral impact. Here was a clear case where it did have a message, converted into organizational work and linked to the grassroots. It was not the social message that was the problem as much as the ability to convert it into a programme, policy and organizational vision. What, perhaps, Congress organizations couldn't do, social activists did. It is this gap that needs to be narrowed as a follow-up to the BJY.

Future and Follow-Up to the BJY

The strength of the current regime is the way it has projected a universalist approach to civil solidarity. In making a case for '*sabka saath, sabka vikas*', the RSS–BJP combine not only projected themselves as creating new nationalist unity, but in the process more effectively replicated the